Yiqiao Jin (Ahren)

Last Updated: Oct. 31, 2026

Final-year CS Ph.D. candidate with **40+ research papers**, including **26 top-tier conference and journal publications**.
yjin328@gatech.edu | ahren2040@g.ucla.edu | (470) 962-0241
ahren09.github.io | scholar.google.com/citations?user=eY85qm4AAAAJ | linkedin.com/in/ahren-jin | github.com/Ahren09

Research Interests

Large Language and Vision-Language Models; Post-Training and Reinforcement Learning; LLM Agents and Multi-Agent Systems; Vision-Language-Action (VLA) Models; World Models; Embodied AI and Robotics.

Education

Georgia Institute of Technology, School of CSE — Aug. 2022 – Present
Ph.D. Candidate in Computer Science; GPA: **4.0/4.0**. Advisor: Srijan Kumar.
MLCommons ML and Systems Rising Stars, 2026.

University of California, Los Angeles (UCLA) — Sep. 2018 – Dec. 2021
B.S. in Computer Science; GPA: **3.82/4.0**.
Undergraduate Research Assistant, ScAi (June 2021 – June 2022). Advisors: Yizhou Sun and Wei Wang.

Industry Experience

Amazon — Aug. 2026 – Nov. 2026
Applied Scientist Intern — Santa Clara, CA

- Develop joint policy and world model networks for long-trajectory agentic tasks.

Waymo — May 2026 – Aug. 2026
Ph.D. Intern — Mountain View, CA

- Developed a unified VLM for embodied AI perception in outdoor scenes across diverse weather, geographic regions, and lighting conditions (patent pending).
- Integrated metric scene geometry and spatial reasoning through a multi-stage training pipeline combining geometric supervision with instruction tuning.

J.P. Morgan AI Research — June 2025 – Aug. 2025
Research Scientist Intern — New York, NY

- Developed SlideAgent (ACL 2026 Main Conference; patent pending) and MM-BizRAG (ACL 2026 Industry Track).

Visa Research, *Research Collaborator (Under Visa Research Grants)*, Remote — Aug. 2024 – May 2025

- Developed SARA (ACL 2026 Main Conference, Oral).

Adobe Research, *Research Scientist Intern*, San Jose, CA — May 2024 – Aug. 2024

- Developed ScreenLLM (Web Conference 2025 Companion).

Microsoft Research Asia (MSRA), Social Computing Group, *Research Scientist Intern*, Beijing, China — Dec. 2020 – July 2022

- Developed FinerFact (AAAI 2022 Oral), SureFact (KDD 2022 Oral), PFIT (AAAI 2023 Oral).

Amazon, Fulfillment By Amazon (FBA), *Software Engineer Intern*, Seattle, WA — June 2020 – Sep. 2020

IBM, China Development Laboratories, *Software Engineer Intern*, Beijing, China — June 2019 – Sep. 2019

Publications

First-Authored Conference Papers

1. *SlideAgent: Hierarchical Agentic Framework for Multi-Page Visual Document Understanding*. **ACL 2026 (Main)**.
2. *SARA: Selective and Adaptive Retrieval-augmented Generation with Context Compression*. **ACL 2026 (Main, Oral)**.
3. *AgentReview: Exploring Peer Review Dynamics with LLM Agents*. **EMNLP 2024 (Main, Oral)**.
4. *MM-Soc: Benchmarking Multimodal Large Language Models in Social Media Platforms*. **ACL 2024**.
5. *Better to Ask in English: Cross-Lingual Evaluation of Large Language Models for Healthcare Queries*. **Web Conference 2024 (Oral)**.
6. *Predicting Information Pathways Across Online Communities*. **KDD 2023 (Oral)**.
7. *Code Recommendation for Open Source Software Developers*. **Web Conference 2023 (Oral)**.
8. *Prototypical Fine-tuning: Towards Robust Performance Under Varying Data Sizes*. **AAAI 2023 (Oral)**.
9. *Towards Fine-Grained Reasoning for Fake News Detection*. **AAAI 2022 (Oral)**.

Other Conference Papers

1. *MASCOT: Multi-Agent Socio-Collaborative Companion Systems*. **EMNLP 2026 (Main)**.
2. *CultureVLM: Characterizing and Improving Cultural Understanding of Vision-Language Models for over 100 Countries*. **EMNLP 2026**.
3. *AgentArk: Distilling Multi-Agent Intelligence into a Single LLM Agent*. **NeurIPS 2026**.
4. *Reasoning Is Not All You Need: Examining LLMs for Multi-Turn Mental Health Conversations*. **ACL 2026 (Main)**.
5. *MM-BizRAG: Rethinking Multimodal Retrieval-Augmented Generation for General Purpose Enterprise Q&A*. **ACL 2026 (Industry)**.
6. *Sysformer: Safeguarding Frozen Large Language Models with Adaptive System Prompts*. **ICLR 2026**.
7. *Beyond Magic Words: Sharpness-Aware Prompt Evolving for Robust Large Language Models with TARE*. **ICLR 2026**.

8. *MedHalu: Hallucinations in Responses to Healthcare Queries by Large Language Models*. **ICWSM 2026**.
9. *Protein Large Language Models: A Comprehensive Survey*. **EMNLP 2025**.
10. *A Survey on Efficient Large Language Model Training: From Data-centric Perspectives*. **ACL 2025 (Main)**.
11. *CompeteAI: Understanding the Competition Dynamics of Large Language Model-based Agents*. **ICML 2024 (Oral)**.
12. *Large Language Models Can Be Contextual Privacy Protection Learners*. **EMNLP 2024 (Main)**.
13. *Prototypical Reward Network for Data-Efficient RLHF*. **ACL 2024 (Main, Oral)**.
14. *Towards Fair Graph Anomaly Detection: Problem, Benchmark Datasets, and Evaluation*. **CIKM 2024**.
15. *Semi-Offline Reinforcement Learning for Optimized Text Generation*. **ICML 2023**.
16. *Reinforcement Subgraph Reasoning for Fake News Detection*. **KDD 2022 (Oral)**.

Journal Papers

1. *Deconstructing the ethics of large language models from long-standing issues to new-emerging dilemmas: a survey*. **AI and Ethics, 2025**.

Workshop Papers

1. *Beyond Structural Unification: A Perspective and Roadmap on Unified Multimodal Models*. **NeurIPS 2026 Workshop on Linguistic Principles for Foundation Models**.
2. *UniSD: Towards a Unified Self-Distillation Framework for Large Language Models*. **COLM 2026 LLA Workshop**.
3. *TextReg: Mitigating Prompt Distributional Overfitting via Regularized Text-Space Optimization*. **COLM 2026 Efficient Reasoning Workshop**.
4. *SciEvo: A 2 Million, 30-Year Cross-disciplinary Dataset for Temporal Scientometric Analysis*. **AAAI 2025 Good-Data Workshop (Best Paper Award)**.
5. *Empowering Interdisciplinary Insights with Dynamic Graph Embedding Trajectories*. **KDD 2025 TGL Workshop**.
6. *ScreenLLM: Stateful Screen Schema for Efficient Action Understanding and Prediction*. **Web Conference 2025 Companion**.
7. *ProteinGPT: Multimodal LLM for Protein Property Prediction and Structure Understanding*. **ICML 2025 FM4LS Workshop**.
8. *UniGuard: Towards Universal Safety Guardrails for Jailbreak Attacks on Multimodal Large Language Models*. **AAAI 2025 DAI Workshop**.
9. *RNA-GPT: Multimodal Generative System for RNA Sequence Understanding*. **NeurIPS 2024 MLSB Workshop**.

Preprints

1. *TimeRSI: Towards Self-Improved Agentic Deployment for Time-Series Foundation Models*.
2. *Science Utopia? Closed-Loop LLM Simulation of Academic Research Ecosystems*.
3. *From Knowledge Access to Source Learning: Developing Source-Specific Competence*.
4. *Can Language Models Learn to Reject Their Own Bad Reasoning Steps?*
5. *Consistency Should Be the Priority for Unified Multimodal Models*.
6. *Topological Structure Learning Should Be A Research Priority for LLM-Based Multi-Agent Systems*.
7. *Efficient Knowledge Probing of Large Language Models by Adapting Pre-trained Embeddings*.
8. *The Influence of Text Variation on User Engagement in Cross-Platform Content Sharing*.
9. *Large Language Model Agent: A Survey on Methodology, Applications and Challenges*.
10. *A Comprehensive Survey of Evaluating Multimodal Foundation Models: Hierarchical Perspective and Extensive Applications*.

Patents

1. *Reliability-Informed Dense Geometry Estimation with Vision-Language Models*. Waymo, 2026. Patent pending.
2. *Hierarchical Agentic Framework for Multi-Page Visual Document Understanding*. J.P. Morgan AI Research, 2025. Patent pending.

Leadership

Communications Chair, Georgia Tech SCSGSA — Aug. 2024 – Present

Honors and Awards

- Best Paper Award, AAAI Good-Data Workshop. — 2025
- Roblox Graduate Fellowship Finalist. — 2024
- AAAI Student Scholarship (3 times). — 2025, 2023, 2022
- Microsoft Research “Star of Tomorrow” Award of Excellence. — 2021
- UCLA Dean’s Honor List (5 times). — 2019 – 2021